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SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 19, 2026

SJC again asserts new housing rule is ‘valid’ law

But issue likely to arise in campaign for governor

By Andrew Brinker, John R. Ellement, and Jeremiah Manion
GLOBE STAFF

Two years ago, a controversial housing law stirred a small uprising of cities and towns against the state.

Known as the MBTA Communities Act, the law requires municipalities served by the T to make room for more multifamily housing. Many towns had spent years actively shutting out housing development, and the new law led to heated public meetings, contentious referendums, and a flurry of lawsuits.

That uprising was dealt a significant blow Friday, when the Supreme Judicial Court again ruled in support of MBTA Communities, concluding for a second time that the housing measure is “a valid general law.”

The unanimous ruling came in a challenge to the 2021 law by the Select Board of Marshfield, one of 177 communities required to make way
SJC, Page A5

No big jump seen in teen use of pot amid legalization

Backers of repeal measure cite additional concerns

By Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The campaign behind a ballot question to repeal legal recreational cannabis in Massachusetts says it is responding, in part, to a threat of higher marijuana use among teens.

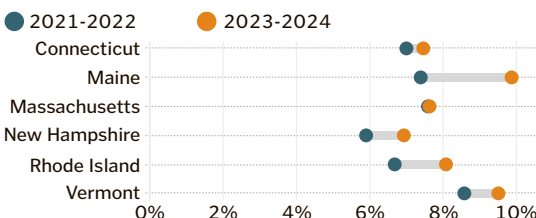
But data indicates legalization hasn’t led to a major increase in usage rates among underage young people. With the repeal question coming before voters in November, many experts said they feel conflicted.

“I’m not a fan of how things have gone down in Massachusetts, but I don’t think that repealing everything is going to be a panacea,” said Dr. Kevin Hill, director of addiction psychiatry at Beth Israel Deaconess Medical Center and a professor at Harvard Medical School.

Debates over legalization’s impact on teens
MARIJUANA, Page A10

Shifts in youth marijuana use rates by state in New England

Data show the share of youths ages 12-17 who reported using marijuana within the last month.



SOURCE: National Survey on Drug Use and Health
SCOOTY NICKERSON/GLOBE STAFF

Chaos slams immigration court

Rescheduling, fast judgments stun lawyers in Chelmsford

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

CHELMSFORD — The Trump administration’s overhaul of the immigration system has propelled

days of chaos here this week at the immigration court.

A wave of suddenly rescheduled cases, moved months or years earlier from their original dates, has overwhelmed the infrastructure at

the court — leaving immigrants and their attorneys alarmed and confused. Several newly appointed judges taking on cases here lack immigration law experience. One of them appeared unprepared to han-

dle the sheer volume of cases assigned to him.

In courtrooms, families with young children waited more than six hours for their cases to be heard. One judge had about 150 cases on his docket in one day, mechanically
IMMIGRATION, Page A6

ON THE STREET



PHOTOS BY CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

As the warm days wind down, Summer Street still offered signs of the season this week. From top: A jogger passed a mural titled “More LOVE is OK”; people walked through a shaft of light; a couple shared a moment during the morning commute.

Patrick Clancy, wife will be on TV as DA still weighing next steps

By Shelley Murphy and Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF

and Chloe Craft
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The wife of Patrick Clancy is slated to make her first public

appearance Sunday when the two participate in a joint interview on CBS’ “60 Minutes,” a rare public outing by the couple that would broadcast their position on the case internationally, as prosecutors decide whether

to retry his former wife for the killing of their three children.

In a brief teaser video posted Friday on CBS’s morning news shows, Dr. Rachel Danis discusses how she met Patrick, their marriage, Patrick’s life af-

ter the January 2023 killings of the children, and the spotlight the murder trial of Lindsay Clancy has put on them. She also defended Patrick against baseless conspiracy theories that have spread online accus-

ing him of being involved in the deaths of the children, and she described the love he had for his family.

“I don’t understand how the story’s been so twisted, but I
CLANCY CASE, Page A10

Kash Patel, the FBI director, temporarily halted some cooperation with the agency’s counterpart in Canada over media references to 9/11. **A2.**

Methuen’s former police chief was committed to jail to serve 30 days for circumventing civil services rules in hiring. **B1.**

Revolution Wind has completed construction of its 65-turbine wind farm off Rhode Island and Connecticut. **D1.**

Cooler heads prevail

Saturday: Not as warm. High: 61-66. Low: 51-56.

Sunday: Clouds, rain. High: 61-66. Low: 54-59. Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

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